REPO RADAR

pixelfx: setup guide

What it is: a free, MIT-licensed JavaScript library of 244 pixel art effects (fire, explosions, lightning, ice, UI, pickups and more). Every effect is a small piece of code. Repo: https://github.com/patch-gg/pixelfx

Install (Node 18 or newer)

1. In your game project: `npm i github:patch-gg/pixelfx`
2. Or clone the repo and run `npm install`, then render an effect to a sprite sheet:

```
node tools/render.mjs fire/campfire --sheet
```

1. Try another: `node tools/render.mjs ice/frost-nova --sheet`

What we measured in a sandbox (no GPU, empty environment)

- `npm install`: about 1 second.
- fire/campfire: 90 frames rendered in about 1.4 s.
- ice/frost-nova: 103 frames rendered in about 2.7 s.
- Each run wrote a transparent sprite sheet PNG, a contact sheet and an Aseprite-style JSON file.

3 ways to use it

1. **Browser game (canvas, Phaser, PixiJS):** import `createFrame`, `createFx` and `composite` from the library, then draw each effect on your canvas.
2. **Any engine (Godot, Unity, GameMaker...):** export sprite sheets with `tools/render.mjs`; the JSON works with Aseprite importers.
3. **Recolor it:** pass a `palette` option (dark-to-bright hex ramp) so a fire can burn blue.

Sources

- https://github.com/patch-gg/pixelfx (README, LICENSE)
- Our own sandbox run, 2026-11-01

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